

CP2 Report & Presentation Requirements

Thanhntl2

Duration: 15 minutes + 5 minutes Q&A

Location: In-person at NVH

Presentation Slot Sign-up: Link will be sent to leaders in Slack for Leaders Only. Team leader will book 1 slot for the entire team

Deadline for Presentation Submission: **BEFORE PRESENTATION SLOT in Week 5**

Presentation Slide Submission Link: <https://forms.gle/4UPqGJBQ4UCBMx33A>

Deadline for Paper Report Submission: **23:59', 08/02/2026**

Paper Report Submission Link: <https://forms.gle/x8zuUR8JKxjMVxkd7>

Paper Report (150 points)

1. Understanding Market
 - 1.1. Market Validation (without MVP testing)
 - 1.1.1. Provide an overview of your market: the name of your market, size of market, sales data, growth projections, current state of the market, future projections, etc.
 - 1.2. [Porter's Five Forces](#) diagram (Draw the diagram & indicate High/Moderate/Low for each force)
 - 1.2.1. [Competitive Rivalry](#): How many competitors does your startup have? How are their products/services compared to what you are planning to build?
 - 1.2.1.1. Example: the airline industry has intense competition. Major players such as American Airlines, Delta Air Lines and United Airlines often differentiate themselves by reducing costs, improving customer experience and launching new routes to attract passengers (Forbes)
 - 1.2.2. [Threat of New Entrants](#): Is it easy for new competitors to enter your market? What's the [Barriers to Entry](#)? Could they threaten existing companies?
 - 1.2.2.1. Example: an established company with significant resources can lower prices to maintain a competitive edge over new entrants. However, new competitors can easily weaken your business's position and quickly disrupt the status quo (Forbes)
 - 1.2.3. [Threats of Substitution](#): How likely are your target customers to switch to a different product/service?

- 1.2.3.1. Example: In the beverage industry, consumers can choose from many beverages including carbonated soft drinks, bottled water, juices, energy drinks, coffee, tea and alcoholic beverages. That's why beverage companies must explore niche markets, introduce limited-edition flavours and change their packaging to differentiate themselves (Forbes)
- 1.2.4. [Buyer Power](#): How much influence do the targeted customers have on the market?
 - 1.2.4.1. Example: companies such as Apple let consumers customise their devices with various features, colours and accessories. They consistently upgrade their products with new features because it's easy to transition to alternative brands or products (Forbes)
- 1.2.5. [Supplier Power](#): How much influence do your suppliers have over the market?
 - 1.2.5.1. Example: the automotive industry has many suppliers for engines, electronics and tires. However, a relatively small number of companies supply critical components such as semiconductor chips, which grants them substantial power (Forbes)
- 1.3. Provide analysis of Porter's Five Forces diagram: Base of the 5 forces, what is the competitiveness (the profit potential) of your market? How can you position your startup to defend against these 5 forces?
2. Expert Interviews (2 experts, minimum 6 months of experience in relevant field)

Automatic Failure of CP2 if not done

 - 2.1. Profile & contact information of experts
 - 2.2. Learning Points from notes taken during interviews:
 - 2.2.1. What does the market look like according to them?
 - 2.2.2. What you should beware of?
 - 2.2.3. What is their experience with your targeted customers?
 - 2.2.4. Anything else?
3. Understanding Competition (find as many competitors as possible for this section, complete 9 companies & your startup to qualify for highest grade of this section)
 - 3.1. Competitive Analysis Framework:
 - 3.1.1. Complete **Competitive Analysis Framework** following the template: [Competitive Analysis Framework | EXE101 | Thanhnt12](#)
 - 3.1.1.1. Instructions for completing Competitive Analysis Framework:

- 3.1.1.1.1. Find & fill information for 9 competitors and your own startup in order to qualify for the maximum grade for this section. Students are encouraged to find as many as they can for a more comprehensive analysis in Actionables Drawn from Framework.
- 3.1.2. After completion of the Competitive Analysis Framework, proceed to complete **Actionables Drawn from Framework** following the template: [Competitive Analysis Framework | EXE101 | Thanhntl2](#)
- 3.1.2.1. Instructions for completing Actionables Drawn from Framework:
 - 3.1.2.1.1. Using the information provided in Competitive Analysis Framework, fill-in the template.
 - 3.1.2.1.2. The competitions here must be the same as in the framework
- 3.1.3. Tell me: what commonalities do you see on the tables? What most competitions are doing well or doing badly? Is there an opportunity for you to win?

3.2. [Advance, Optional] Competitors' Criteria Table (if you chose to do this, you don't have to do the competitive framework above)

3.2.1. You decide which metric you would use to identify which company is what type of competitor

3.2.2. Define your metrics:

Metrics	Your Startup	Direct competitors	Indirect competitors	Substitute competitors	New entrants
Name of metric #1	Define your startup according to metric #1	Define direct competitors according to metric #1	Define indirect competitors according to metric #1	Define substitute competitors according to metric #1	Define new entrants according to metric #1
Name of metric #2	Define your startup according to metric #2	Define direct competitors according to metric #2	Define indirect competitors according to metric #2	Define substitute competitors according to metric #2	Define new entrants according to metric #2
...	...	...	...	...	...

3.2.2.1. Metrics: each metric should be specifically relevant to your sector. For example, if you are a chip designer, your metrics can be: ecosystem of software and services, performance of Relative Throughput/Frames Per Second (FPS)/Flops (Floating Point Operations Per Second), etc.

- 3.2.2.2. Direct competitors: Same product/service, same target customers, solving the same problems/needs/desires, same approach solving the problems/needs/desires
- 3.2.2.3. Indirect competitors: Different product/service, same target customers, solving the same problems/needs/desires, different approach solving the problems/needs/desires
- 3.2.2.4. Substitute competitors: Alternative (replacement) product/service, compete for same target customers
- 3.2.2.5. New entrants: Same product/service but recently entered the market

3.2.3. Now that you define what constitutes each of the 4 categories of competitor. Place real-life competitors into each category:

Direct competitors	Indirect competitors	Substitute competitors	New entrants
Name of direct competitor #1	Name of indirect competitor #1	Name of substitute competitor #1	Name of new entrants #1
Name of direct competitor #2	Name of indirect competitor #2	Name of substitute competitor #2	Name of new entrants #2
...	...	...	...

3.2.4. Analysis:

- 3.2.4.1. What is the overall competitive landscape you see?
 - 3.2.4.2. What strengths & weaknesses do you see in each category?
 - 3.2.4.3. What do you think you should do to win or to defend your startup against them?
 - 3.2.4.4. Do you see an opportunity for collaboration or partnership?
- Etc.

4. Understanding Buyers

4.1. Buyer Personas (a representation of a type of customer, you can draw more than 1 persona as needed)

- 4.1.1. Personas answer the question “Who are we designing for?”
- 4.1.2. Define your buyer personas by graphics and/or paragraphs. **For some startups, buyers may not be users.** Buyers are those buying (giving you money) your product/services. They could be businesses or individual consumers depending on the type of startup you decide to build.
- 4.1.3. Provide the following key elements (be as specific as you can):
 - 4.1.3.1. Descriptive name: A descriptive name for your customer

- 4.1.3.2. Demographics: Ask yourself, “Who is my buyer?”
 - 4.1.3.2.1. If Buyer is an individual, provides: age, gender, education, income or spending power, place, etc.
 - 4.1.3.2.2. If Buyer is an organization/business, provides: company demographics, such as business size, industry, place and geography, etc.
- 4.1.3.3. Psychographics: Ask yourself, “why do they buy?”
 - 4.1.3.3.1. Provides values, spending habits or patterns, aspirations that Buyer is looking for when buying
- 4.1.3.4. Challenges & goals: Ask yourself, “What challenges are your buyers looking to solve and how can your product or service address that need?”
 - 4.1.3.4.1. State the challenges & goal and provide answers to “What are your potential buyers hoping to achieve? What are the effects of achieving this goal for the company and for them personally? What are the consequences of failing to achieve these goals?”
- 4.1.3.5. Influences: Ask yourself, “What affects a buyer’s buying decisions?”
- 4.1.3.6. Objections: Putting yourself in your Buyer’s perspective
 - 4.1.3.6.1. Answers: What objections or reasons to hesitate will your buyer find when considering your product or service? Are you a new company competing with established competitors? Does your new product seem risky when compared to “tried and true” alternatives?
- 4.2. Surveys - A survey is any study where you collect data by asking people questions (100 people minimum) [COMPLETE BUYER PERSONA BEFORE WRITING SURVEY] **Automatic Failure of CP2 if not done. Students complete each step below:**
 - 4.2.1. Define your objective and target audience:
 - 4.2.1.1. Clearly explain what you are trying to learn from your survey
 - 4.2.1.2. Clearly explain from whom you are trying to obtain the data:
 - 4.2.1.2.1. After the broad population is defined, tell me your sample - a subset of your target audience who will actually take the survey
 - 4.2.2. Survey method:
 - 4.2.2.1. Define your method:

- 4.2.2.1.1. Make sure it match your target audience, you stated objective and available resources
- 4.2.2.1.2. Examples (but not limited to):
 - 4.2.2.1.2.1. Online surveys
 - 4.2.2.1.2.2. Telephone and face-to-face surveys
 - 4.2.2.1.2.3. Panel surveys
- 4.2.3. Questionnaire Design:
 - 4.2.3.1. Question types used:
 - 4.2.3.1.1. Minimum 2 types: multiple choice, rankings, open-ended responses, likert scale, matrix, slider, ordinal scale, etc.
 - 4.2.3.1.2. Minimum 7 questions
 - 4.2.3.1.2.1. All question should be clear, direct and **without bias** (not a leading question that incentivise respondent to prefer one answer over another)
- 4.2.4. Recruitment:
 - 4.2.4.1. How do you find the people (your sample) to take your survey?
 - 4.2.4.2. Is the contact information (if you obtained it from another source other than its originator) consistent with any terms of use, any data protection laws?
- 4.2.5. Incentives and compensation:
 - 4.2.5.1. Are you offering any incentives and compensation for survey takers? If you are, provide details.
- 4.2.6. Anonymity:
 - 4.2.6.1. For the purpose of the course, the survey **MUST** have a demographic section (facts about your survey takers) with questions about either: age, gender, education, etc.
 - 4.2.6.2. The survey **MUST** collect the respondent's email address. The name of respondent are not required
- 4.2.7. Tools:
 - 4.2.7.1. Provide the tools you are using to collect the data and the tools you are using to analyze the data.
- 4.2.8. Data Retention:
 - 4.2.8.1. If data you collect can identify a respondent, the data should be kept in a separate & secure place with anonymised code for each respondent.
- 4.2.9. Informed Consent:

- 4.2.9.1. No one should ever be compelled to complete your survey.
- 4.2.9.2. Survey is completed based on the voluntary completion, this voluntary completion can be taken as consent for this data to be used in your research.
- 4.2.9.3. If personal data is collected, make sure respondents know that data will not be published and will be destroyed at a given period (I suggest 6 months).

4.2.10. Sampling, Response Rate and Selection:

- 4.2.10.1. If you are claiming that your survey results are applicable to a larger population beyond those that responded (means you have a representative sample), be able to justify your recruitment database was genuinely representative and be sure those who didn't respond would have given the same answers.

4.2.11. Analysis:

- 4.2.11.1. Closed questions can be used for statistical analysis: find differences between groups within the sample or correlations between responses to questions
- 4.2.11.2. Single value statistics, things like: "40% of respondents love this feature on our product" has little research relevance unless you can compare that to another external figure or other hypothesis.

4.2.12. Conclusions based on survey result

- 4.2.12.1. At the minimum, answering the following questions:
 - 4.2.12.1.1. Demographically, who are they? What does this mean to your startup, your product/service?
 - 4.2.12.1.2. What real problems are customers dealing with in your market? Why? How many of them meet the same problems?
 - 4.2.12.1.3. Are customers interested in your idea? Why & how?
 - 4.2.12.1.4. Are customers willing to pay to get their problem solved? Why & how?
 - 4.2.12.1.5. And any other questions you see fit to answer.

4.3. [Advance, Optional] Pain Point Interviews

- What are pain point interviews?
 - 30-40 minutes interview online/via phone
 - Led by 1 person using the script or guide

- Supported by at least 1 other note taker (can use AI)
 - Focus on hearing stories from the interviewer
- What is the goal?
 - Listen for pains, their severity, context, and any processes surrounding them. If 1 person is conducting the interview, the other listening needs to take notes throughout the interview. Try to capture pains, insight, quotes, and magic-wand wishes so you can see patterns.
 - Scripts evolve between sessions, patterns emerge, and eventually your interviews start to focus on the prioritization of pains versus the digging for pain
- Who are you talking to?
 - **At least 10 people per stakeholders group**
 - Multiple stakeholders groups
- When do you stop?
 - When you can reach diminishing returns from doing another interview
 - When you can almost predict what they will say
 - Usually 2-3 weeks
 - When you can start to finish people's sentences, then you know you have found common pain and common pain is where you find big markets
- What do you learn?
 - Explicit pains, per stakeholders
 - Severity of pains
 - Context and processes surrounding each pain
- Summarize and Synthesize the Pain you heard
 - Step 1: Put the data and thoughts from your interviews into a manageable form by summarizing key points from each interview
 - Step 2: Look for patterns. Identify key themes, and then assemble a preliminary hierarchy and priority based on feedbacks from stakeholders
 - Step 3: Extract the key insights. What lies beneath the surface of what people told you? Go beyond what was said
 - Step 4: Craft the message. Find the strongest way to convey the message and meaning.
- Synthesis of your pain point interview gives you a complete overview of where your potential customers and their stakeholders see dangerous weaknesses in their businesses or personal lives.
- Answer the 3 questions using your result of the interview:
 1. Is there real pain?
 2. What is the pain?
 3. Is there a lot of it?
- 5. Actionables
 - 5.1. Market pains
 - 5.1.1. From everything you have done above, is there a real problem/pain/desire? What is the descriptive customer's problem/pain/desire? Is there a lot of it? To what degree can you solve those problems?

5.1.2. *Note: merely stating the problems without analysis based on evidence presented above will result in a maximum of 3 out of 5 points for this section*

5.2. Market solutions

5.2.1. Based on the identified customers' problem above,

5.2.1.1. **If it is real, describable and there is a lot of it**, what are your proposed solutions to their problem/pain/desire?

5.2.1.2. **If the problem/pain/desire is not real or it is not describable or there is not a lot of it**, what changes are you proposing to your idea? Why are they suitable changes?

5.2.2. *Note: merely stating the solutions without explanation based on evidence presented above will result in a maximum of 3 out of 5 points for this section*

6. Appendix

6.1. Experts' profile

6.2. Survey data (raw)

7. References List

7.1. Follow [Harvard Referencing](#)

8. AI disclosure statement

Paper Format

- Font Size: 12 (body text), 12-16 (title, sections)
- Font: Arial or Times New Roman
- Double-spacing, 2.5cm margins
- Citing: [Harvard Referencing](#)
- **Page count: 5-25 pages** (pages beyond 25 will not be graded)
- Page count does not include title page, within tables and figures, footnotes, equations, graphics (photos, charts, etc.) or References list

Survey Tool: [Qualtrics](#), Google Forms, etc.

In-person Presentation (50 points | 15 minutes + 5 minutes Q&A)

1. Market summarised
 - 1.1. Concisely explain Market validation
 - 1.2. Concisely explain Porter's five forces diagram
 - 1.3. Concisely explain Expert's interview learning points
2. Competition summarised
 - 2.1. Concisely explain Competitive Analysis Framework

- 2.2. Concisely explain Actionables Drawn from Framework
 - 2.3. Provide Framework analysis
 - 2.4. [\[Advance, Optional\] Competitors' Criteria Table & Analysis](#)
3. Buyers summarised
 - 3.1. Concisely explain Buyer personas graphic(s)
 - 3.2. Concisely explain Surveys method & conclusions
 - 3.3. [\[Advance, Optional\] Pain Point Interviews](#)
4. Actionables summarised
 - 4.1. Concisely explain Market pains
 - 4.2. Concisely explain Market solutions
5. AI disclosure statement

Tool: Canva, Microsoft Powerpoint, Google Slides, Prezi, Keynote, Gamma, etc.

Survey Tool: [Qualtrics](#), Google Forms, etc.

Lecturer's policies:

1. If you believe doing something else beside/in replacement of the guidance I have given you for each Checkpoint is better, DO IT! Keep in mind that some explanation needs to be given for your choice so let me know of your reasoning.
2. All work must be completed by team members: copying or replicating or hiring any other current/past team's work or someone else to do your work will result in a score of ZERO & failure of EXE101 course. Any team member who does not contribute or does not contribute fully on their agreed assigned parts will receive a score of ZERO or a reduction to all checkpoint grades at the end of the semester.
3. Late submission equates to a score of ZERO for the entirety of the submitted work.

4. AI uses & help are allowed; however,

Be aware:

- Do NOT trust anything it says. Facts from AI tools can be taken from various sources, some of which are Wiki (Wikipedia is the largest of them). These Wiki sources are editable by ANYONE, so check the authenticity of the source.
- **AI uses' disclosure:** Please include a disclosure statement (a short paragraph) at the end of the presentation and/or report explaining what you used the AI for and what prompts you used to get the results. Failure to include this statement will result in a failing grade for the assignment.
- There are **pass/fail critical-thinking questions** during the presentation of the submitted materials. If the student cannot answer these questions sufficiently, the student will receive a failing grade for the assignment and have to resubmit & represent at a later time.

[Recommendation] Pass/fail critical-thinking questions practice tool: [ChatGPT-Chat with your document](#)

5. Presentation's attendance: All team members are required to be present. Team members who do not attend the presentation receive 50% of the team's score unless provided acceptable reasons for absence with proof (email to thanhntl2@fe.edu.vn). Students should NEVER take a leave of absence in any other class to attend EXE101 checkpoints presentation.
6. Before asking me (your lecturer) to make an exception for you, ask yourself this question first: "Is it impossible to honor my commitment, I mean truly impossible?". If the answer is YES, I am willing to hear your explanation. If the answer is NO, my answer is NO.